

Tolga Çakan

Industrial Engineer · Product & Operations

tolgacakan.vercel.app

Istanbul, Turkey tolgacakan@gmail.com +90 542 262 00 42 github.com/tolgacakan14 ORCID 0000-0001-7444-9079

PROFILE

Industrial engineer and product manager who specifies a product and then builds it. Experience spans product management at a cryptocurrency exchange, Kaizen process improvement on a Toyota assembly line, digital marketing at an agency, and an AI engineering programme. Co-founder of TAB Marketing, where I lead product development from customer discovery and competitor research through requirements, supplier coordination, production and launch – turning ambiguous ideas into structured actions and working products.

EXPERIENCE

Mar – Jul 2025	Intern, De Marke Agency Digital marketing and on-site organisation at international tournaments.
Jan – Feb 2025	Product Intern, BTCTurk Technology Conducted competitor benchmarking, market research and user testing; supported product decisions through internal dashboards, structured reporting and cross-functional collaboration.
Jun – Jul 2024	Engineering Intern, Toyota Motor Manufacturing Turkey Assembly line logistics and continuous improvement through Kaizen, 5S, root cause analysis and standard work instructions. Built an internship process improvement project and presented it to Toyota's senior management. On-site, Sakarya.

OWN VENTURES & PROJECTS

TAB Marketing – co-founder & product lead 2026 – present
Co-founded and led the development of seven NFC, QR and web-based product lines serving 15+ businesses across Istanbul and Sakarya. Managed customer discovery, competitor research, requirements, product design, supplier coordination, production and rollout from concept to launch.
Krone – web game innerclock.vercel.app
Mini-games, multiplayer rooms, daily challenges and leaderboards. React, TypeScript.
FeedDetox – prototype Next.js
Reads what a social feed has learned about a user and generates content packs to steer the algorithm elsewhere.

SKILLS

Product	Product management · benchmarking · market and competitor research · user testing · requirements and scoping · roadmapping · dashboards and reporting · stakeholder communication
Engineering	Python · SQL · JavaScript · TypeScript · React · Next.js · Vite · HTML · CSS · Git · Vercel
Analysis	Excel · VBA · data analysis · reporting · Kaizen · 5S · root cause analysis · standard work · ergonomics · waste reduction · production and vendor logistics · supply chain
Tools	PowerPoint · Google Workspace · Figma · UI/UX collaboration · print and packaging production
AI	LLM-assisted workflows · prompt design and iteration · Anthropic tooling · AI product research
Blockchain	Exchange and DeFi mechanics · published sector research
Events & ops	Large-scale forums and conferences · programme and speaker planning · sponsorship · budget · venue logistics · team leadership on the day
Physical × digital	NFC systems · QR routing · retail and hospitality deployment
Languages	Turkish (native) · English (professional working proficiency)

EDUCATION

- Istanbul Bilgi University – BSc Industrial Engineering. Graduated June 2026
- Fen Lisesi – Sakarya, Turkey

AWARDS, PROGRAMMES & CERTIFICATES

- Best Senior Design Project Award, Industrial Engineering, Istanbul Bilgi University (2026) – "Improvement of Precision, Quality and Worker Well-Being in Sock Manufacturing: Case of ÖRS Textile". Ergonomic and process redesign on a live production line that cut material waste and scrap and more than doubled line efficiency. Top five of its term; presented at CSRP 2026
- AI Engineering Internship, FlyRank AI (2026) – remote, project-based: five reviewed assignments and a capstone
- AI Fluency: Framework & Foundations, Anthropic Education (Jul 2026) · [verify](#)
- Claude 101, Anthropic Education (Jul 2026) · [verify](#)

PUBLICATION

- Chapter XI, "Blockchain ve Eğlence Sektörü", in *Blockchain Teknolojileri ve Sektörel Etkileri*. Nobel Bilimsel Eserler, 2022, as independent researcher. ISBN 978-625-433-825-0

CREATIVE PROJECTS & LEADERSHIP

- Vice President & Operations Lead, Atatürkçü Düşünce Kulübü, Bilgi University (2021–2024). Led end-to-end planning and execution of 10+ large-scale forums and conferences for students across Istanbul – the largest a live panel drawing 4,000+ attendees – coordinating speakers, sponsors, budgets, venues and on-site teams
- Editorial Director, Bilgi Blockchain Club (2021–2024). Commissioned and edited the club's publications and forum programme
- He For She, Erasmus+ Youth Exchange – Saaremaa, Estonia (December 2023). Youthpass certified
- European Summer School, Blockchain to Financial Markets – Prague (2025)
- Drums & songwriting, *son sek'* – one album, two singles, live shows ([Spotify](#))